

Rankings.io

Messaging Playbook

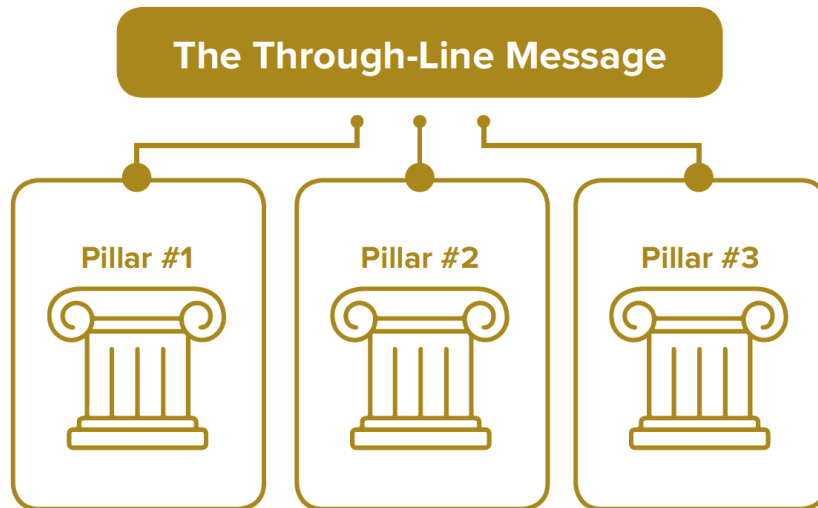
This is your messaging & copywriting guide.

The purpose of this guide is to know how to communicate your message in your copy in a way that stands out and inspires people to take action.

Phase 1: What You Do, And Why You're *Different*

The Core Message & Messaging Pillars

The Through-Line Message



The Throughline Message:

We help elite personal injury law firms dominate first page rankings.

Pillar #1: Specialize In SEO Only

Pillar #2: Solely Focused On Personal Injury Attorneys

Pillar #3: Results-Based Agency: "Proof, Not Promises"

The Through-Line Message:

We help hyper-competitive personal injury attorneys dominate first-page rankings and become recognized as the leading firm in their metro area.

We do this by:

Specializing In Search Engine Optimization

We are the only digital marketing agency that's solely focused on SEO for elite personal injury law firms, with an entire team dedicated to helping our clients dominate search results, with unparalleled industry expertise.

Only Working With Personal Injury Firms With Aggressive Growth Targets

We only work with competitive personal injury firms who are hungry for growth, because we know the industry inside and out.

Focusing On Proof Over Promises

We use a scientific approach to get our clients serious ROI, and have an unrelenting conviction to be the best.

Core Message Examples

Example 1:

Become The Top Personal Injury Attorney In Your Area
And Stay There

Example 2:

Dominate Your SEO Rankings And Be Recognized As
"The Firm" In Your Territory
Let The Reputation You've Worked Hard To Build Be Seen Online

Example 3:

How The Largest Personal Injury Firms Rank For The Most
Competitive Search Terms
"The Attorney Rankings System," Used By The Only SEO Firm That Works Only With Personal Injury Lawyers

Example 4:

If Your Firm Is #1 in the Courtroom, Then Why Are You Showing Up On Page 2 of Google?
It's Time To See Your Firm Recognized On The First Page

The Positioning Triangle™ (Aka Who You Are)

We Are:

- Dominant: Our unrelenting conviction to be the best drives us to do everything possible to ensure that the personal injury law firms working with us dominate the search results.
- Humble: We never, *ever* want to look braggy, so we practice extreme humility and stay grateful.
- Trustworthy: We give proof, not promises, by delivering results, and never leave our clients in the dark.

Our Values:

- Send & Delete: We are so reliable that (when someone assigns a task) a sender feels that they can simply "send and delete." There is no need for them to set a reminder to check in on the progress; they know that sending it was all that needed to be done.
- Team Player: We are not jerks. This doesn't mean that everyone needs to be a Pollyanna and be relentlessly positive...but we approach situations in a constructive and proactive manner.
- Commitment to Quality: We always strive to produce the highest quality work, so we never settle for just "fine."

We Are Committed To:

- A complete focus on SEO for personal injury attorneys; we are always ahead of the game.
- A scientific approach to data research, deconstructing information to get the best results.
- The domination of the most competitive markets, with dedicated teams for each part of the ranking process.
- Creating a personal touch for our clients, not just saying we're "the best at customer service," but fully embodying our commitment to service.

Other Credibility Points To Use

(Awards, publications, testimonials, certs, etc.)

- Awards/Accolades:
 - Inc 5000 Four Years in a Row: [Inc. 5000](#)
 - Recognized as a Top B2B Service Provider: [Clutch](#)
 - National Excellence Winner: [UpCity](#)
 - Top 1-3 results, in the most competitive metro areas (like San Diego, Houston, Philadelphia, and Chicago), as well as entire states and even nationwide, for some of the most competitive keywords
- Contacts:
 - Website: <https://rankings.io>
 - Twitter: <https://twitter.com/Rankingsio>
 - Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/rankingsio>
 - Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/rankingsio/>
 - LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/company/rankingsio>
- Origin Story:
 - Any other references that would be helpful for me to see:
<https://www.starterstory.com/stories/how-i-started-an-seo-agency-f-or-lawyers-generating-3-6m-year>

Copywriting Goals & Principles

The Rankings.io Commitment When Crafting Content/Copy

- We are transparent, knowing our clients want to work with someone they can trust.
- We showcase “proof not promises,” and let our results do the talking.
- We communicate honestly and are to-the-point.
- We are trusted advisors and true partners in our clients’ success.

With every piece of content we publish, we aim to:

- Educate our clients, leaving them better than when we found them.
- Share proof of results rather than making empty promises.
- Highlight the value in working with us (demonstrating why we're able to charge higher than the industry standard).
- Practice humility, never bragging, and always staying grateful.
- Stay ahead of the game at all times.
- Keep the focus on us, and never talk bad about our competitors.

Voice & Tone

Formal Or Casual?

On a scale of 1-10, how would you describe the way you interact with your audience?

(1 being extremely professional and formal, 10 being super casual)

We are an 8, maintaining professionalism while keeping messages short and casual.

- We always end client emails sincerely and respectfully.
- If we're addressing an older attorney, we always use the formal "Mr." until they give us permission to use their first name.
- We always mirror our clients, and in the legal space, other attorneys refer to themselves in the formal "Mr.", and that's how we present ourselves: formal, relaxed, and "business casual."
- Think about it like this: You'll wear a button-up shirt in the first meeting, but after you've built some rapport, it's okay to wear a t-shirt.
- Communication examples:
 - "Thank you" vs "Thanks"
 - NO dirty humor
 - If you're ever unsure, always lean towards formal over casual

Authoritative Or Relaxed?

On a scale of 1-10, how would you describe your tone?

(1 being serious/authoritative/stern, 10 being light/airy/fun/relaxed)

We are a 7; our clients appreciate being talked to straight and given the facts

- We're professional, but fun and tasteful

Downbeat Or Optimistic?

On a scale of 1-10, how would you describe how you communicate with your audience?

(1 being more downbeat, 10 being overly optimistic)

We are a 5, we don't wear "rose-colored glasses" and make overly optimistic or false promises—we're realistic.

- We are fully accountable: We own what happens, even if things go bad, we are clear with how we're going to address the issue, and solutions for fixing it.
- We don't leave our clients in the dark.

Humor

On a scale of 1-10, how would you describe how you communicate with your audience?

(1 being no humor, 10 being sarcastic jokes for days)

We are a 6, using clean humor when it's appropriate

- We'll regularly work SEO puns, marketing puns, and other lighthearted banter into our marketing.
- We'll use *some* self-deprecating language, but it must be done with purpose and class.

Curse Words

On a scale of 1-10, how would you describe your brand's writing?

(1 being no curse words, 10 being cussing up a storm)

We are 0...

- We use no curse words or dirty humor. We maintain professionalism.

Sentence Structure

Do you tend to use long sentences, tell stories, make jokes, and take a long time to get to the point?

We are a 5, doing whatever we can to get the point across to our clients quickly.

- We keep things short and to the point; our clients' time is limited.
- Put it this way, in the office, if an email is too long, we'll just pick up the phone and call the person.

Common Words & Phrases

What are some common words or phrases that you use a lot?

Words

- Clients: Personal Injury SEO (Not "Law Firm SEO")/Personal Injury Law Firm/Injury attorney/Strategic Partners (Not "Outsourcing")
- Dominate: Unrivaled/Preeminent/Pinnacle/Elite/Dominate/First/Rankings
- Quality: Bespoke/Craft/Scrupulous Attention to Detail/Creative Foundry/Without Compromise
- Scarcity: Limited Availability/Apply Now/
- Innovation: Avant-Garde/Trailblazers/Reject Conformity/Boutique
- Revenue: Clients/Cases/Sign More Clients and Cases
- Legalese: SEO Discovery (Not Audit)/Practice Areas (Not Services)

Phrases

- "Thanks to everyone who's made this happen..." "Grateful to our clients who have made this possible..." (when addressing an award or accolade)
- "Rank on the first page"
- "#1 ranking position"
- "When you're ranked #1, you're perceived as #1"
- "At the end of the day, SEO is a production game - the reason the investment is higher is we do so much more"
- "Iron triangle: good, fast, cheap - we're good and fast, but not cheap"

Phase 2: Who You Help

Who do your clients identify as? What are some differentiators about their demographics?

Our Ideal Client:

- Partners, Managing Partners, Founders, Owners, CEOs, Attorneys
 - Most commonly Founders/Owners and CEOs
 - At big firms, it's usually the Managing Partner we're speaking to.
 - At mid-market firms (around or just at 7 figures), it's usually the CEO or Founder.
 - At larger eight-figure firms, there's usually a Director of Marketing or a CMO, out in front of the CEO or Founder.
- It's an 80/20 mix: 80% mid-market firms, and 20% larger eight-figure firms.

Their Personality:

- Many of our clients are former athletes and hypercompetitive; they are the jock-y, masculine types with an aggressive edge, but they're sweethearts on the inside.
- 98% of them are male, between 45 and 60 years old, and many are in their second marriages.
- They value luxury and status, and want to work with the best.
 - When they come to us, they already know/think we're expensive because we're specialists and we are perceived as highly valuable, not solely based on our results, but because of the investment it takes to work with us.
- They are Ivy Leaguers dedicated to self-improvement, and elevation of their brand.
- They splurge on expensive vacations, and take any opportunity to take photos of their cars, celebrity friends/acquaintances, and will showcase anything that communicates they are #1.
- They are also not very happy in life (although they don't show it), always looking for the next material object, or level of success, to try and feel whole.
- They hate being seen as "less than," especially in matters relating to their professional reputation, and hate being seen as "fake," too.
- And they hate being told "no."
- But they are self-aware: They know they're driven by ego, and they own it, even being self-deprecating at times.

The Ideal Client Communicator™

Where they are now (Current Situation):

Current Situation

- You're the biggest firm in your area, yet when you search for yourself, inferior attorneys are outranking you.
- You may not even be on page 1 of the results for "personal injury lawyer" and "car accident lawyer."
- You've worked with other SEO agencies in the past and:
 - They didn't get you any results, or weren't driven to get results.
 - They weren't transparent, and they never followed up, so you started to ask yourself: *What are they doing every month? What kinds of backlinks are they getting? How many blog posts have they written?*
 - Then, you may have found yourself trying to learn SEO because the agency wasn't getting the job done.
- You've got decent lead flow, but you know you're missing out (you might even have dominated your digital market in the past.)
- You want to be visible, and have your online presence reflect the reputation you worked so hard to build.

Phrases They Use

- "I'm not showing up at all in the search results!"
- "How do I rank #1?"
- "I signed up with this agency, they worked hard for a month and then just coasted."
- "We've never been able to rank in SEO—you're our last shot, if you don't work, we're not going to do SEO."
- "We ranked really well in the past, but maybe we're going to invest somewhere else."
- "I know how many leads SEO can bring, because I used to rank/dominate."

Driving Forces:

- Vanity: They want to be ranked #1 for vanity reasons, even if they only get a couple clients from it.
- Unrelenting: Things are never quite good enough; they're always reaching for the bigger, better, and faster ways to do things.

How do they feel?

- Frustrated
- Like nothing is ever "enough"
- Fear of being seen as fake or inferior

Where they want to go (Desire/Destination):

- You want to type in “car accident lawyer” on your phone and see yourself on the first-page results.
- You want to be the dominant firm in your market, to completely control the area, and you know SEO rankings will help you do that.
- You’ve invested thousands of dollars in billboards, radio, TV, and you want to crack the SEO code so you can solidify yourself as “**the** firm” in your area.
- You’re the best, you know it, your caseload proves it, so do your results, and you want your online presence to show it.
- You want more leads from your SEO efforts, but really you just want to make sure you’re #1 when people search for your practice area keywords.

How do they feel?

- Seen & validated/Powerful & dominant/Proud & respected
- High Status

What’s stopping them from getting to where they want to go (Objections/Fears):

Fears:

- Another agency left a bad taste in your mouth because they: didn’t deliver results (or weren’t hungry enough for them), kept you in the dark about what was going on, or their content wasn’t consistent and lacked quality.
- You’re worried about committing to SEO again because of this bad experience, and you want to make sure you’re choosing the right partner, but you don’t know who to trust.
- You’re competitive, and concerned about exclusivity, and want whoever you work with not to be working with the competition.

Objections:

- Geographic Exclusivity Conflict: Want us to work exclusively with their firm.
- Timing: They’re not interested at the moment.
- Price: We’re too expensive for them.
- Qualification: They aren’t at the right level, have less than a 4.0 rating, aren’t in a practice area we support at this time, or they’re international.

How do they feel?

- Frustrated/Confused/Angry

What are three matching mindsets you both share?

1. We both want to be the best.
2. We both want to win—we're very competitive, and personal injury law is the most competitive vertical that exists.
3. We both specialize in an area, and know the ins and outs.

Filters & Qualifiers

We only serve personal injury lawyers who...

- Can handle an influx of new clients (if you only take a few cases, this won't work.)
- Communicate honestly, and often (to implement effectively, we need to talk.)
- Want a true partnership with a trusted advisor that delivers results (from content creation to the technical SEO stuff, don't worry, we got it.)
- Can afford to invest \$10,000/month+ (to provide exceptional service and serious ROI, we serve one client per metro area and go all in for them.)
- Are eager and hungry to grow (not lifestyle attorneys—go-getters who are the best and want the world to know it.)

Phase 3: How You Help Them

The Unique Method: Your Unique Process For Guiding Your Clients To A Result

The Attorney Rankings System

*The 5-Step SEO Process For Personal Injury Firms Who Want To:
Outrank The Competition And Let Their Online Presence Reflect The Reputation They've
Worked So Hard To Build*

1. Intelligence Upgrade

We'll do a deep dive into your geographic location, your goals, and thoroughly evaluate your firm's SEO viability—we'll let you know if you've got what it takes to dominate your territory (or if you don't).

2. SEO Discovery

You'll get a comprehensive analysis of the competitive landscape, gain clarity on your firm's current digital standing, designate benchmarks, and have our Data Research Team share what your greatest opportunities are using the resources you already have.

3. Your SEO Game Plan

Based on our findings, we'll create a bespoke SEO campaign tailored specifically to the needs of your firm. The roadmap will be aligned with your goals, and have clear next steps in place so our team can begin execution as soon as you sign off.

4. Three-Prong Execution

We are the only agency that focuses on SEO marketing for personal injury attorneys, which means you save money on research costs (we've already done it and we know what works), get access to keyword strategies most firms don't know about, retain a team of legal writers and editors who create quality legal content, and have dedicated experts at your disposal, including on-site, local, and technical SEO including content and link building, as well as a Spam Department that proactively deals with spam before it hurts your rankings.

5. Evaluate & Adjust

You'll get monthly progress reports, direct access to Chris, and a full summary of results. Most agencies can't measure performance metrics very quickly, but you

have an entire department dedicated to evaluation and iteration.

Communicating Your Main Offer

Who is your Ideal Client for this offer?

- Partners, Managing Partners, Founders, Owners, CEOs, Attorneys
- Most commonly Founders/Owners and CEOs

What is the #1 Problem they have (related to what you're selling)?

- They don't know why they're not ranked #1, and want desperately for their online presence to represent their exceptional reputation, and don't want to be seen as inferior.

What is Your Solution (your product/service name)?

- Personal Injury Law Firm Search Engine Optimization
- The Attorney Rankings System

What is the Primary Benefit?

- Rank on the first page and be seen as the #1 firm in local and surrounding territories.

What are the Secondary Benefits (Practical & Emotional)?

- When you're with prospective clients, out on the golf course, or just at your desk, you can **type "car accident lawyer" into Google and see yourself right on the first page results.**
- Outshine your competitors' online presence, so you can **completely control your market and be seen as "the firm" in your area and its surrounding territories.**

- Never be left in the dark, with monthly reports that give you the full snapshot of where you stand, as you **watch your name climb the rankings, generate high-value leads, and surpass the inferior firms.**
- Eliminate spam and fake reviews with a dedicated “Spam Fighting Department” at your disposal and protect yourself against nasty tactics from competitors who play dirty.
- **Have a team of legal writers and editors who’ve played in your market for years consistently pump out quality content** that showcases your legal proficiency and expertise.
- **Sit at the top of the legal hierarchy and be recognized as the reigning PI firm that you are, because when you’re ranked #1, you’re perceived as #1.**

What is Your Promise?

- Dominate first-page rankings, let your online presence reflect the reputation you’ve worked hard to build, and protect your firm’s good name.
- Our unrelenting conviction to be the best drives us to do everything possible to ensure that the personal injury law firms working with us are dominating the search results.

What’s the price?

- Our minimum monthly engagement is \$10,000.

Is there a Guarantee or Risk Reversal? (PENDING)

- If this isn’t the best experience you’ve had working with an SEO agency in the first 30 days, we’ll give you 100% of your money back plus we’ll also pay the first-month retainer fee for your next SEO agency you hire.

Is there Scarcity/ Urgency? (Time/Quantity)

- We only work with a limited number of clients per metro area.
- Exclusivity *may* be available in your area (limitations apply).
- Rankings.io is *not* for everyone: We are the **ONLY** agency that's solely dedicated to end-to-end SEO (not PPC, YouTube, or anything else) and we have strict criteria for those that we work with.

What are The Questions your Ideal Client is going to need answered before feeling comfortable to buy?

- When will I start seeing results?
- How much does it cost?
- Who have you worked with and what results have they garnered?
- How do I know this won't be like the last experience I had?

What happens next? What is the First Step they can take to begin the process?

**Click Here To Apply And See If You Qualify
And Book Your Complimentary Consultation**

Education-Based Marketing Sample

The 6 P's: Writing Prompts For Your Education-Based Marketing

1. Philosophy

Purpose: Share your unique take on your industry/niche and create a connection based on your core values.

- How The Largest Firms In Your Area Climb The SEO Ranks
- Why Hiring A Legal Marketing Agency Is A Bad Move
- X Tactics The Top Ranked Personal Injury Firms On Google Use
- X SEO Metrics Legal Agencies Don't Track And What That Means For Your Firm

2. Pain Point

Purpose: To identify your audience based on the problem you solve, get their attention by talking about a pain point they experience, and give them context for how you can help them solve it.

- The Personal Injury Attorney's Guide To Fighting Spam Attacks
- How To Outrank Inferior Personal Injury Firms
- X Questions To Ask Before You Hire An SEO Agency
- Here's Exactly How To Rank For Competitive Terms Like "Car Accident Lawyer"

3. Problem & Objection

Purpose: Identify the most common objections they have as to why they haven't solved their problem yet + how you can provide answers.

- X SEO Mistakes Personal Injury Firms Make (Even If They Aren't Aware)
- How Digital Marketing Agencies Can Actually Ruin Your Reputation
- X Steps To Take If Your Personal Injury Firm Isn't Showing Up At All In Search Results
- Here's How The Country's Largest Firms Secure First Page Rankings

4. Proof & Positioning

Purpose: To show your audience that other people know, like, and trust you and have gotten results.

- The SEO Strategy That Increased Cases By X% And Ranked This Firm #1
- The Secret SEO Tool The Largest Firms In Your Area Are Already Using To Outrank You
- “The Best ROI Of Any Marketing”—How This Attorney Ranked #1 For ‘Houston Car Accident Lawyer

5. Process

Purpose: Teach pieces from your signature process so you get your ideal clients results in advance. (You never want to teach the WHOLE process, but rather a part of it.)

- The Worst Ways To Approach Personal Injury Law Firm SEO in 20XX (And What To Do Instead)
- 5-Step Process For Ranking In Top Spots For The Most Competitive Keywords
- The “Attorney Rankings System” For Outranking Local Competition
- Hidden Analytics That Can Wreck Your SEO Rankings

6. Possibility

Purpose: Show your prospects what’s possible for them and their life/business (in a non-douchey way).

- How To Control The Local “Accident Lawyer” Media Field
- Personal Injury Law Firm SEO 101: Dominate Search Results With These X SEO Strategies
- X Reasons You’re Not Ranking On The First Page
- How To Protect Your Online Reputation From Inferior Competitors